26.10 Distinction Between Debentures and Shares

S. No	DEBENTURES	SHARES
1.	Debentures constitute a loan.	Shares are part of the capital of a company.
2.	Middle and Lower Level	Top level
3.	Debenture holder gets fixed rate of Interest which carries a priorities over dividend.	Shareholders gets dividends with a varying rate.
4.	Debentures generally have a charge on the assets of the company.	Shares do not carry any such charge.
5.	Debentures can be issued at a discount without restrictions.	Shares cannot be issued at a discount.
6.	The rate of interest is fixed in the case of debentures	Whereas on equity shares, the dividend varies from year to year depending upon the profit of the company and the Board of directors decision to declare dividends or not.
7.	Debenture holders do not have any voting right	Shareholders enjoy voting right.
8.	Interest on debenture is payable even if there are no profits i.e. even out of capital.	Dividend can be paid to shareholders only out of the profits of the company and not otherwise.
9.	Interest paid on debenture is a business expenditure and allowable deduction from profits.	Dividend is not allowable deduction as business expenditure.
10.	Return of allotment is not required for allotment of debentures.	Return of allotment in e-Form No. 2 is to be filed for allotment of shares.

Navratnas Companies

1. Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)
2. Container Corporation of India (CONCOR)
3. Engineers India Limited (EIL)
4. Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)
5. Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited (HPCL)
6. Mahanagar Telephone Nigam Limited (MTNL)
7. National Aluminium Company (NALCO)
8. National Buildings Construction Corporation (NBCC)
9. National Mineral Development Corporation (NMDC)
10. Neyveli Lignite Corporation Limited (NLCIL)
11. Oil India Limited (OIL)
12. Power Finance Corporation
13. Power Grid Corporation of India Limited
14. Rashtriya Ispat Nigam Limited
15. Rural Electrification Corporation
16. Shipping Corporation of India (SCI)

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